



CANNED FOOD

The ancient Romans preserved food in containers lined with rust-resistant tin. In 1810, the Frenchman Nicolas Appert developed tinned cans to preserve food for Napoleon's army. In 1823, the tin can above, which contained roast veal, was made for a British voyage.

Feeding the world

Every invention made, from hunting tools to computers, would be useless if we were not able to keep ourselves healthy enough to use them. Food is essential for survival, and as Earth's population has grown, it has become even more vital that humans find effective ways of producing ever-greater quantities of nourishing food.



Many farmers came to witness the Jethro seed drill in action.

THE SEED DRILL

Growing crops used to be very hard work, with farmers laboriously scattering seeds in the field by hand. In 1701, Englishman Jethro Tull changed all that with his invention of the seed drill. Pulled along by a horse, this machine carved out neat furrows, then dropped seeds into them, which proved to be a very efficient way of growing crops.



This worker carefully transplants seedlings into empty pots at this modern-day hydroponic farm.